

BIO Francesca Fantini (long)

Francesca Fantini is an Italian saxophonist and artistic researcher whose work moves fluidly between classical music, contemporary repertoire, and free improvisation.

Through sound, gesture, and collaborative performance, Francesca investigates how the body functions as both instrument and site of knowledge, challenging conventional hierarchies of musical form and authorship.

Trained across several European institutions, Francesca earned her Bachelor's degree in Classical Saxophone from Conservatorium Maastricht in 2021. In 2024, she completed a Master's degree in Chamber Music at the Conservatory of Brescia with highest honors. During her Master's Programme, she further expanded her artistic language at the Lithuanian Academy of Music and Theatre in Vilnius, where she focused on free improvisation and contemporary chamber music, developing an approach that bridges rigorous technique with exploratory sonic research.

Francesca has performed across Europe in concert halls, festivals, and experimental spaces, including Muziekgebouw Eindhoven, Saarbrücken Radio Hall, Intro in Situ, Derby Elettrico at "Fondazione i Teatri di Reggio Emilia", Muzikos Ruduo Festival, and Monheim Triennale II. Her performances range from solo improvisations to large ensemble settings, often emphasizing collective processes and real-time composition.

As Artistic Researcher she gave presentations of her work for "Oi Dialogoi" congresses and for the First International Doctoral Symposium of Siena Jazz.

As an educator, she gave lectures and workshops in academies like the Conservatory of Brescia, National Academy of Dance (Rome), and in collaboration with Intro in Situ and Limestones Bookshop.

She is an active collaborator in several international projects, including the contemporary improvisation trio *airkeychains*, the European Music Collective, and Duo Taíta with pianist Yi-Ling Wu.

In 2024, she was recognized as *Artist of the Month* by Giovani Artisti Italiani. She is awardee of the 2026 grant for Levi Campus.

In 2026 she covered the role of Artist in Residence for Intro in Situ, an organisation dedicated to the development of new music and sound art.

Alongside her performance practice, Francesca is currently pursuing a PhD at Roma Tre University investigating how an embodied approach to interpretation can unfold into informed improvisational practice.

BIO Francesca Fantini (short)

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Through sound, gesture, and collaborative performance, Francesca investigates how the body functions as both instrument and site of knowledge, challenging conventional hierarchies of musical form and authorship.

In her music meaningful melodies arise from moments of noise and raw sound material, grounding the performance in an intimate yet powerful atmosphere.

She is currently pursuing a PhD at Roma Tre University investigating how an embodied approach to interpretation can unfold into informed improvisational practice.

She is also Artist in Residence 2026 for Intro in Situ, an organisation that takes care of the development of new music and sound art.